

THE HISTORY DEPARTMENT

EDEXCEL GCSE (9–1) HISTORY • PAPER 2: CONFLICT IN THE MIDDLE EAST, 1945–1995

PUPIL NAME: _____ CLASS: _____ TEACHER: _____

KEY TOPIC 2 • 1964–1973

The Escalating Conflict, 1964–1973

The Cairo Conference, Six-Day War, Resolution 242, Palestinian Resistance & The Yom Kippur War



Primary Visual Source: *Israeli Paratroopers at the Western Wall* • David Rubinger (7 June 1967)

Accession Shelfmark: **GPO-D388-052**

COURSE SPECIFICATION • KEY ENQUIRY SEQUENCE	LEARNT	REVISED
Key Topic 2.1: The Road to War: The Cairo Conference, Water Wars & Skirmishes (1964–67) <i>How did the River Jordan water dispute, creation of the PLO, and 7 April 1967 air clash escalate tensions?</i>	☐	☐
Key Topic 2.2: The Outbreak & Course of the Six-Day War (June 1967) <i>Why was Operation Focus decisive, and how did Israel conquer the Sinai, West Bank, and Golan Heights?</i>	☐	☐
Key Topic 2.3: The Aftermath: Resolution 242 & The Occupied Territories (1967) <i>Why did the Khartoum "Three Noes" and the linguistic ambiguity of Resolution 242 cause enduring deadlock?</i>	☐	☐
Key Topic 2.4: Palestinian Resistance: The PLO, Black September & Munich (1968–1972) <i>How did the Battle of Karameh empower the PLO, and why did factions turn to hijackings and the Munich attack?</i>	☐	☐
Key Topic 2.5: The War of Attrition & The Yom Kippur War (1969–1973) <i>Why did Egypt and Syria achieve surprise, how did the oil embargo impact the West, and why did it lead to peace?</i>	☐	☐

LIVING TIMELINE • PART 1: THE ROAD TO WAR & THE SIX-DAY WAR (1964–1967)

Instructions: As you study each enquiry lesson, complete the timeline missions by sketching and annotating in the corresponding Key Topic boxes below.

JAN 1964 • The Cairo Conference & The Foundation of the PLO

Key Topic 2.1

Thirteen Arab League leaders meet in Cairo to oppose Israel's National Water Carrier. They establish the Palestine Liberation Organisation (PLO) under Ahmad Shukeiri and approve the Headwater Diversion Plan to divert the Hasbani and Banyas rivers away from the Sea of Galilee.

MAY–JUNE 1967 • Straits of Tiran Blockade & UNEF Expulsion

Key Topic 2.1

Spurred by Soviet false warnings, President Nasser demands the immediate withdrawal of UN Emergency Force (UNEF) peacekeepers, moves 100,000 troops into Sinai, and blockades the Straits of Tiran at Sharm el-Sheikh, cutting off Israel's southern oil route (casus belli).

5–10 JUNE 1967 • The Six-Day War & The Conquered Territories

Key Topic 2.2

Israel launches Operation Focus, wiping out the Egyptian Air Force on the tarmac. In six days of mobile warfare, the IDF captures the Sinai Peninsula and Gaza Strip from Egypt, the West Bank and East Jerusalem from Jordan, and the Golan Heights from Syria.

LIVING TIMELINE • PART 2: DIPLOMACY, RESISTANCE & THE YOM KIPPUR WAR (1967–1973)

Instructions: As you study each enquiry lesson, complete the timeline missions by sketching and annotating in the corresponding Key Topic boxes below.

22 NOV 1967 • UN Resolution 242 & The Khartoum "Three Noes"

Key Topic 2.3

The UN Security Council unanimously adopts Resolution 242, establishing the foundational principle of "Land for Peace" (Israeli withdrawal in exchange for Arab recognition and secure borders). At the Khartoum Summit, the Arab League issues the defiant "Three Noes": no peace, no recognition, and no negotiations with Israel.

SEPT 1970 – 1972 • Black September in Jordan & The Munich Olympics

Key Topic 2.4

Operating as a "state within a state" in Jordan, the PFLP blows up three hijacked Western airliners at Dawson's Field. King Hussein's army crushes Palestinian militia strongholds in September 1970, expelling the PLO to Lebanon. In September 1972, the militant splinter faction Black September murders 11 Israeli Olympic athletes in Munich.

6–25 OCT 1973 • The Yom Kippur War & The OPEC Oil Embargo

Key Topic 2.5

Egypt and Syria launch a surprise assault on Yom Kippur. Egyptian infantry blast through the Bar-Lev Line using high-pressure water monitors under a Soviet SAM umbrella. Following emergency US airlifts and an Israeli counter-crossing led by Ariel Sharon, Arab OPEC ministers impose an oil embargo that quadruples global prices, shattering Israeli complacency.

Key Specification Focus: The Cairo Conference (1964) and creation of the PLO; River Jordan water dispute and Headwater Diversion Plan; Syrian-backed fedayeen guerrilla attacks; Israeli reprisal raids and the 7 April 1967 aerial battle over the Golan Heights.

• 'DO NOW' RETRIEVAL DRILL (10 RECALL QUESTIONS)

Score: [/ 10]

1. What 1917 British declaration supported a Jewish national home in Palestine?

2. Which international organisation granted Britain the Mandate for Palestine in 1922?

3. Which Jerusalem hotel was bombed by the Zionist militant group Irgun in July 1946?

4. What was the number of the United Nations Resolution to partition Palestine in 1947?

5. On what date did David Ben-Gurion proclaim the establishment of the State of Israel?

6. Approximately how many Palestinian Arabs became refugees during the 1948–49 War?

7. What 1950 Israeli law granted every Jewish person the right to settle in Israel?

8. Who became President of Egypt in 1954 and emerged as leader of Pan-Arab nationalism?

9. What vital international waterway did Nasser nationalise in July 1956?

10. Which two European powers secretly colluded with Israel in the Protocol of Sèvres (1956)?

• KEY VOCABULARY

HISTORICAL TERMINOLOGY

Define the **Headwater Diversion Plan** and explain how it differed from a conventional border clash as a catalyst for military escalation:

• QUESTION 1(A): EXPLAIN ONE CONSEQUENCE [4 MARKS]

[4 MARKS • 5 MINS]

Explain one consequence of the Arab League's Headwater Diversion Plan (1964–66). [4 marks]

PFC Guidance: Point (IDF airstrikes and artillery destroying Syrian earthmoving machinery) • Fact (Israel targeted Banyas canal diversion works) • Consequence (Halted Arab water diversion but sharply escalated cross-border shelling and Syrian backing for Fatah guerrilla raids).

Sentence Stems: One major consequence was... • Specifically, when Syria attempted to divert the headwaters of the Jordan... • Consequently, this resulted in...

• QUESTION 1(B): EXPLAIN ONE CONSEQUENCE [4 MARKS]

[4 MARKS • 5 MINS]

Explain one consequence of the 7 April 1967 air battle over the Golan Heights. [4 marks]

PFC Guidance: Point (Humiliating defeat for the Syrian Air Force) • Fact (Israeli Mirage jets shot down six Syrian MiG-21s and flew victory passes over Damascus) • Consequence (Provoked false Soviet intelligence reports in May 1967, pressuring Nasser to mobilise in Sinai).

Sentence Stems: One major consequence was... • Specifically, during the aerial clash on 7 April 1967... • Consequently, this directly triggered...

You may use the following in your answer: • The closure of the Straits of Tiran (May 1967) • The expulsion of UNEF from Sinai
You must also use information of your own.

Explain the Egyptian-Jordanian defence pact (May 30) encircling Israel, and Israel launching Operation Focus pre-emptive airstrikes on 5 June.

Cairo Conference (1964) • National Water Carrier • Headwater Diversion • Fatah raids • 7 April air battle • UNEF peacekeepers • Straits of Tiran • Sharm el-Sheikh • casus belli • Operation Focus

[illegible]

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Key Specification Focus: The outbreak of war on 5 June 1967; Operation Focus (destruction of Arab air forces on the ground); the three-front campaign in Sinai, West Bank/Jerusalem, and Golan Heights; Israel's total military victory and capture of strategic territory.

• 'DO NOW' RETRIEVAL DRILL (10 RECALL QUESTIONS)

Score: [/ 10]

1. In which city was the Palestine Liberation Organisation (PLO) founded in January 1964?

2. Who was elected the first chairman of the PLO in 1964?

3. Which Palestinian guerrilla faction was founded by Yasser Arafat in Kuwait in 1959?

4. What strategic high ground overlooking Galilee kibbutzim was controlled by Syria before 1967?

5. How many Syrian MiG-21s were shot down by the Israeli Air Force on 7 April 1967?

6. What peacekeeping force was deployed in Sinai following the 1956 Suez Crisis?

7. What narrow strait did President Nasser close to Israeli shipping on 22 May 1967?

8. Which coastal outpost at the entrance of the Gulf of Aqaba was fortified by Egyptian guns?

9. Which monarch of Jordan flew to Cairo on 30 May 1967 to sign a joint defence pact with Nasser?

10. Who was appointed Israeli Minister of Defence on 1 June 1967 on the eve of war?

• KEY VOCABULARY

HISTORICAL TERMINOLOGY

Define a **Pre-emptive Strike** and explain why Israeli commanders argued Operation Focus was necessary for national survival on 5 June 1967:

• QUESTION 1(A): EXPLAIN ONE CONSEQUENCE [4 MARKS]

[4 MARKS • 5 MINS]

Explain one consequence of Operation Focus on the morning of 5 June 1967. [4 marks]

PFC Guidance: Point (Complete destruction of the Egyptian Air Force on the ground) • Fact (Over 300 of Egypt's 420 combat aircraft wiped out in 3 hours using runway-crater bombs) • Consequence (Gave Israel total air supremacy, leaving Egyptian ground forces in Sinai defenseless without air cover).

Sentence Stems: One major consequence was... • Specifically, when the Israeli Air Force launched Operation Focus... • Consequently, this enabled the IDF to...

• QUESTION 1(B): EXPLAIN ONE CONSEQUENCE [4 MARKS]

[4 MARKS • 5 MINS]

Explain one consequence of Jordan entering the war on 5 June 1967. [4 marks]

PFC Guidance: Point (Israel's capture of East Jerusalem and the entire West Bank) • Fact (Jordanian artillery shelled West Jerusalem based on false Egyptian reports; Israeli paratroopers counter-attacked) • Consequence (Israel captured the Old City and annexed East Jerusalem, displacing 300,000+ Palestinians).

Sentence Stems: One major consequence was... • Specifically, after King Hussein ordered Jordanian forces to fire... • Consequently, this resulted in...

Structure across two distinct analytical aspects: • Protection of Galilee Farming Settlements & Water Sources • Topographical High Ground & Strategic Early Warning

Explain how capturing the Golan permanently transformed Israel from a vulnerable defensive position into the dominant military power on its northern frontier.

Religious escarpment • Galilee kibbutzim • Hula Valley • Syrian artillery bunkers • General David Elazar • Mt Hermon • radar early warning • Damascus buffer • strategic depth • 9-10 June assault

[illegible]

7/14

Key Specification Focus: The creation of the Occupied Territories (Sinai, Gaza, West Bank, East Jerusalem, Golan Heights); Palestinian refugee crisis (300,000+ displaced); the Khartoum Conference and the "Three Noes" (Aug–Sept 1967); UN Resolution 242 and "Land for Peace" (Nov 1967).

• 'DO NOW' RETRIEVAL DRILL (10 RECALL QUESTIONS)

Score: [/ 10]

1. How many days did the Arab-Israeli war of June 1967 last?

2. Name the massive desert peninsula captured by Israel from Egypt in 1967.

3. Which territory along the Mediterranean coast was captured from Egyptian military administration?

4. Which territory on the west bank of the River Jordan was captured from the Kingdom of Jordan?

5. Which holy sector of Jerusalem was captured and annexed by Israel in June 1967?

6. Which strategic volcanic plateau was captured by Israeli troops from Syria on 9–10 June?

7. Approximately how many Palestinian Arabs became refugees following the 1967 war?

8. What city in Sudan hosted the Arab League summit in August–September 1967?

9. What famous formula summarized the Arab League position at the Khartoum Summit?

10. What core diplomatic formula was introduced by UN Security Council Resolution 242?

• KEY VOCABULARY

HISTORICAL TERMINOLOGY

Define the diplomatic principle of "Land for Peace" and explain why its interpretation caused 30 years of diplomatic stalemate after November 1967:

• QUESTION 1(A): EXPLAIN ONE CONSEQUENCE [4 MARKS]

[4 MARKS • 5 MINS]

Explain one consequence of the Six-Day War for Palestinian civilians in the West Bank. [4 marks]

PFC Guidance: Point (Mass displacement and military occupation) • Fact (Over 300,000 Palestinians fled across the River Jordan; 1 million fell under Israeli military rule) • Consequence (Deepened the refugee crisis and drove young Palestinians into armed guerrilla groups like Fatah).

Sentence Stems: One major consequence for Palestinian civilians was... • Specifically, during and immediately after the June 1967 fighting... • Consequently, this resulted in...

• QUESTION 1(B): EXPLAIN ONE CONSEQUENCE [4 MARKS]

[4 MARKS • 5 MINS]

Explain one consequence of the Khartoum Arab Summit (August–September 1967). [4 marks]

PFC Guidance: Point (Entrenched total diplomatic deadlock via the "Three Noes") • Fact (Eight Arab heads of state declared: No peace, no recognition, no negotiations with Israel) • Consequence (Convinced Israeli leaders that Arab states would never negotiate, prompting Israel to retain the lands and build settlements).

Sentence Stems: One major consequence was... • Specifically, Arab leaders resolved at Khartoum that... • Consequently, this entrenched deadlock because...

You may use the following in your answer: • The Khartoum Conference (August–September 1967) • UN Security Council Resolution 242 (November 1967)
You must also use information of your own.

Explain British drafting of Resolution 242 establishing "Land for Peace", deliberate linguistic ambiguity ("territories occupied"), and resulting deadlock.

Occupied Territories • 300,000 refugees • Khartoum Summit • "Three Noes" • UN Resolution 242 • Lord Caradon • "Land for Peace" • "territories occupied" • Gunnar Jarring • military governor

[illegible]

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KT2.4: Palestinian Resistance: The PLO, Black September & Munich (1968–1972)

RETRIEVAL • VOCABULARY • EXAM PRACTICE

Key Specification Focus: The rise of independent Palestinian resistance: the Battle of Karameh (1968) and Yasser Arafat taking leadership of the PLO; PFLP aircraft hijackings and Dawson's Field (1970); Black September in Jordan (1970) and expulsion to Lebanon; the Munich Olympics massacre (1972) and Israeli reprisals.

• 'DO NOW' RETRIEVAL DRILL (10 RECALL QUESTIONS)

Score: [/ 10]

1. What core diplomatic formula was established by UN Resolution 242 in November 1967?

2. What were the famous "Three Noes" declared by Arab leaders at Khartoum in 1967?

3. Name three of the five territories captured by Israel in the Six-Day War.

4. How many Palestinian refugees fled into Jordan following the 1967 war?

5. Which Palestinian guerrilla movement was led by Yasser Arafat?

6. What does the acronym PLO stand for?

7. In what year was Yasser Arafat elected Chairman of the PLO?

8. Which Egyptian president expelled UNEF and closed the Straits of Tiran in 1967?

9. What was the 1949 armistice border between Israel and Jordan known as?

10. What term describes Palestinian armed guerrilla fighters who "sacrifice themselves"?

• KEY VOCABULARY

HISTORICAL TERMINOLOGY

Explain the crucial tactical difference between **Fedayeen Guerrilla Warfare** and **International Terrorism** as methods adopted by Palestinian factions after 1967:

• QUESTION 1(A): EXPLAIN ONE CONSEQUENCE [4 MARKS]

[4 MARKS • 5 MINS]

Explain one consequence of the Battle of Karameh (March 1968) for the Palestinian national movement. [4 marks]

PFC Guidance: Point (Surge in volunteers and Fatah taking leadership of the PLO) • Fact (Palestinian fedayeen resisted an Israeli armored raid in Jordan, killing 28 IDF soldiers) • Consequence (Celebrated as a moral victory after 1967, transforming Arafat into a hero and leading to his 1969 election as PLO Chairman).

Sentence Stems: One major consequence was... • Specifically, when Palestinian fedayeen fought at Karameh... • Consequently, this resulted in...

• QUESTION 1(B): EXPLAIN ONE CONSEQUENCE [4 MARKS]

[4 MARKS • 5 MINS]

Explain one consequence of the Black September conflict (1970) for the PLO. [4 marks]

PFC Guidance: Point (Total military expulsion of the PLO from Jordan to southern Lebanon) • Fact (Following the Dawson's Field airliner hijackings, King Hussein ordered his army to crush armed militias in Amman) • Consequence (The PLO lost its border with Israel and established "Fatahland" in Lebanon, pushing radical cells toward international terror).

Sentence Stems: One major consequence was... • Specifically, after the Dawson's Field hijackings... • Consequently, this forced the PLO to...

Structure across two distinct analytical aspects: • Global Media Recognition of the Palestinian Problem • International Moral Outrage & Israeli Targeted Retaliation

[illegible]

Key Specification Focus: The War of Attrition (1969–70) and the Bar-Lev Line; death of Nasser and succession of Anwar Sadat; reasons for the 1973 attack; surprise assault on Yom Kippur (6 Oct 1973); water-monitor breach of the Bar-Lev Line; superpower involvement (US and Soviet airlifts); Sharon’s counter-crossing; the OPEC oil embargo; military and political outcomes.

• 'DO NOW' RETRIEVAL DRILL (10 RECALL QUESTIONS)

Score: [/ 10]

1. What Israeli hostage crisis occurred at an international sporting event in September 1972?

2. What covert Mossad retaliation operation was authorized by Golda Meir following Munich?

3. Which desert airstrip in Jordan was used by the PFLP in 1970 to blow up hijacked airliners?

4. Which country became the main headquarters for the PLO after being expelled from Jordan in 1971?

5. What static artillery border conflict was fought along the Suez Canal in 1969–70?

6. Who succeeded Gamal Abdel Nasser as President of Egypt following Nasser’s death in 1970?

7. What fortified sand-rampart defensive line did Israel construct along the Suez Canal?

8. What method did Egyptian engineers use to blast through the sand ramparts of the Bar-Lev Line?

9. On what Jewish holy day did Egypt and Syria launch their coordinated surprise attack in 1973?

10. Which vital international waterway remained closed to shipping between 1967 and 1975?

• KEY VOCABULARY

HISTORICAL TERMINOLOGY

Define the **Bar-Lev Line** and explain why Egyptian military planners deployed high-pressure water monitors to breach it on 6 October 1973:

• QUESTION 1(A): EXPLAIN ONE CONSEQUENCE [4 MARKS]

[4 MARKS • 5 MINS]

Explain one consequence of Operation Badr on 6 October 1973. [4 marks]

PFC Guidance: Point (Successful breach of the Bar-Lev Line and crossing of the Suez Canal) • Fact (80,000 Egyptian infantry crossed on rafts, washed away sand ramparts, and established bridgeheads under SAM missiles) • Consequence (Shattered Israeli confidence in defensive invincibility and destroyed 150+ Israeli tanks in 48 hours).

Sentence Stems: One major consequence of Operation Badr was... • Specifically, on the afternoon of 6 October 1973... • Consequently, this resulted in...

• QUESTION 1(B): EXPLAIN ONE CONSEQUENCE [4 MARKS]

[4 MARKS • 5 MINS]

Explain one consequence of the OPEC oil embargo in October 1973. [4 marks]

PFC Guidance: Point (Global energy crisis and quadrupling of world crude oil prices) • Fact (Arab oil states cut output 5% monthly and embargoed the US and Netherlands; oil rose from \$3 to \$12 a barrel) • Consequence (Caused inflation, fuel queues, and economic distress in the West, forcing the US into active peace mediation).

Sentence Stems: One major consequence was... • Specifically, when Arab OPEC oil ministers enacted the embargo... • Consequently, this directly forced...

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Key Topic 2.5: Yom Kippur War & Oil Crisis (1969–1973) • Knowledge Retrieval & Exam Practice

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You may use the following in your answer: • The surprise attack on 6 October 1973 • The OPEC oil embargo
You must also use information of your own.

Explain Arab OPEC oil embargo quadrupling world oil prices, superpower nuclear DEFCON 3 tension, and Henry Kissinger securing a UN ceasefire on 24 October.

Operation Badr • Bar-Lev Line • water monitors • SAM-6 missiles • Golan Heights • Operation Nickel Grass • Ariel Sharon • Third Army encirclement • OPEC oil embargo • DEFCON 3 • Henry Kissinger

[illegible]

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STUDENT ASSESSMENT RECORD • KEY TOPIC 2 TRACKER

Paper 2: Conflict in the Middle East, 1945–1995 • The Escalating Conflict (1964–1973)

PUPIL: _____	TARGET GRADE: 	PREDICTED: 	ATTITUDE: 1 • 2 • 3 • 4 • 5
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#	ENQUIRY / LESSON ASSESSMENT	DO NOW (10M)	Q1 CONSEQ (8M)	EXTENDED (8M)	LESSON TOTAL
1	KT2.1: Cairo Conference & Water Wars	[/10]	Q1(a+b): [/8]	Q2 Narr: [/8]	[/26]
2	KT2.2: Straits of Tiran & Six Day War	[/10]	Q1(a+b): [/8]	Q3 Impt: [/8]	[/26]
3	KT2.3: Occupied Territories & Res 242	[/10]	Q1(a+b): [/8]	Q2 Narr: [/8]	[/26]
4	KT2.4: Black September & Munich 1972	[/10]	Q1(a+b): [/8]	Q3 Impt: [/8]	[/26]
5	KT2.5: Yom Kippur War & Oil Embargo	[/10]	Q1(a+b): [/8]	Q2 Narr: [/8]	[/26]
KEY TOPIC 2 CUMULATIVE ASSESSMENT TOTALS		Do Now: [/50]	Q1 Total: [/40]	Ext Total: [/40]	[/130]

TEACHER FORMATIVE ASSESSMENT • WWW / EBI FEEDBACK		Effort Grade: []
WHAT WENT WELL (WWW): 	EVEN BETTER IF (EBI): 	
Teacher Signature: _____		Date: _____

INTERACTIVE DIGITAL QUIZZING HUB • SCAN FOR INSTANT RETRIEVAL PRACTICE

Scan with smartphone camera to open live interactive self-marking quizzes

KT2.1 Water Wars  SCAN TO QUIZ	KT2.2 Six-Day War  SCAN TO QUIZ	KT2.3 Res 242  SCAN TO QUIZ	KT2.4 Munich 1972  SCAN TO QUIZ	KT2.5 Yom Kippur  SCAN TO QUIZ
Best Score: [/10]	Best Score: [/10]	Best Score: [/10]	Best Score: [/10]	Best Score: [/10]